Talking with Children

3.4 Staff sometimes talk with children in a playful way (EX: use nonsense syllables with babies; teach finger plays to toddlers, use rhymes, chants, songs, or other verbal play)

Observe two different Children

Encouraging Children to Communicate

3.1 Staff sometimes initiates conversations with children (Ex: babble back and forth with baby; copy bay's sounds, respond to baby's crying with verbal response; have short back and forth toddler interaction)

Observe Three Times

Encouraging Children's Use of Books

NEVER , EVER.... Use books as a time out activity or a transition activity.

Children must be interested in going to the book area.

ART

3.4 Staff name colors as children use art materials (Ex: “That is a RED crayon”)

Observe once

Dramatic Play

3.4 Staff name some objects children experience in their dramatic play.

Observe for 2 different children

Math/Number

3.2 Staff sometimes talk about shape or size when children use materials (Ex: point out differently sized dolls; name shapes of toys.)

Observe once

Math/Number

3.3 Staff sometimes point to each item as they count for children (Ex: count objects in a book; count how many children; count number of crackers being put on a plate)

Observe once

Display for Children

5.4 Staff point out and talk to the children about displayed materials (Ex: Handwashng display – talk about correct handwashing and why)

Observed Once

Diapering/Toileting

5.4 Some staff interactions observed (Ex. Staff explain what is happening and why; help with and talk about handwashing; point out and talk about display child sees; counts number of child's toes and feet). Also, Talk the child through the entire diaper process. Ask for her permission tochange her.

Observed Twice

Diapering/Toileting

5.4 Some staff interactions observed
(Ex. Staff explain what is happening and why; help with and talk about handwashing; point out and talk about display child sees; counts number of child's toes and feet). Also, Talk the child through the entire diaper process. Ask for her permission to change her.

Observed for each child sampled

Health Practices

5.5 Some positive teacher interaction observed during health related practices
(EX. Staff show child how to wash hands while describing the steps; teach how to wipe nose, out on jacket; tell children why health care is needed; it will decrease the spread of germs)

Observe Three times

Safety Practices

5.4 Simple explanation of why children cannot do unsafe actions usually provided while staff stop child (EX: “Feet on the floor, Rosie. I don’t want you to fall and get hurt”; “Use your walking feet David, or you will knock your friends over”)

Observe Once

Encouraging Vocabulary Development

5.3 Most talk is about the 'here and now' but other topics about past and future experiences are included as well
(Ex: staff talk about what happened with other significant people; what child is at home, what they did yesterday outdoors.)

Observe "other topic" twice

Encouraging Vocabulary Development

5.4 Staff make obvious comparisons and contrasts to help children understand words (Ex: “Red rattle; Blue rattle”; “your shirt is pink just like my shirt”; “you are going fast and I am walking slowly”; “this is a big ball, this ball is small”)

Observe twice

Responding to Children's Communication

5.4 Staff say words child is trying to communicate (EX: " oh you are hungry. Lets get your bottle" when baby cries: " You wanted Maria's doll? I'll help you find a doll", when toddler screams, Baby holds up arms and staff says, "Pick you up? OK"

Observe 2 different children

Staff Use of Books with Children

5.1 Book used with interested children informally, with one child or a very small group

Observe Once

Staff Use of Books with Children

5.3 Staff point out and name some pictures in book with the child.

Observe for two different children

Staff Use of Books with Children

5.4 Staff read text in book as well as talk about the story or pictures.

Observe once

Art

5.3 Staff talk with children briefly about their artwork (Ex: “What did you draw?”, “I like your red circle”

Observe for two different children

Music and Movement

5.2 Music and/or Movement activities are individualized

(Ex: quiet lullabies sung to sleepy children; staff do one-on-one finger plays with children; sing in children's home language, sing a handwashing song as child washes hands.

Observe once

Blocks

5.4 Staff talk with interested children about their block play (Ex: talk with infants about what they are doing with blocks. Ask older children about what they are building; talk about how blocks fall down.)

Observe for 2 different children

Dramatic Play

5.4 Staff sometimes interact positively, and never negatively, while children engage in dramatic play (Ex: help put on dress ups; model how to use materials, talk about children's play)

Observe 2 different children

Nature/Science

5.3 Staff point out and talk about nature/science materials and/or experiences (Ex: discuss weather and our clothing; watch rain from the window; blow and talk about bubbles; show how to use a magnifying glass)

Observe once

Math/Number

5.2 Staff correctly compare shapes, quantity, or sizes (Ex: use words “more” or “less” when referring to groups of objects; use “smallest”, “bigger” or other size words when referring to objects.)

Observe once

Math/Number

5.3 Staff count objects for children in an engaging manner (Ex: playfully count child's toes when changing diaper; point to or move blocks as they are counted; pat child on head as each child is counted; count crackers as they are put onto child's plate.)

Observe for 2 different children

Math/Number

5.4 Staff use number songs, chants, nursery rhymes or finger plays with children in an engaging manner.

Observe once

Display for Children

7.3 Staff provide extended talk about displayed material (EX: - Theme Board – talk about the current Theme. Mentioned what they did yesterday.

Observed Twice

Promoting Acceptance of Diversity

7.2 Staff promote diversity in learning activities they do with children (Ex: sing songs in more than one language; use music from varying cultures; use sign language for some words.)

Observe once

Meals/Snacks

7.5 Staff use math talk during feeding times (Ex. Count crackers for child; use words such as more/less, bigger/smaller when appropriate (Ex: -Infants – feeding baby count spoonfuls as you feed. Bottle feeding start with an 8 oz bottle ask her how many ounces will she drink? As she finishes each announce it)

Observed Twice

Diapering/Toileting

7.3 Teaching interactions are frequently observed (Ex: staff teach child self help skills such as handwashing when they are ready; all children are talked to.

Observed for each child sampled

Encouraging Vocabulary Development

7.2 Staff sometime verbally explain the meaning of words (Ex:" it's a mouse... a little furry animal that says squeak, squeak"; "Rain is water falling from the sky", " it's a triangle,, it has three pointy angles and three sides")

Observe twice

Encouraging Vocabulary Development

7.3 Evidence observed that staff change toys, materials and display items to introduce new words and ideas to the children (EX: new photos of children pointed out; new play foods observed being added and talked about; seasonal displays discussed)

Observe once

Responding to Children's Communications

7.3 Staff add more words or ideas to expand what children say (Ex: child holds up toy, staff say " Yes that is a blue truck, see it has wheels", Child says "Banana" staff says "We need to peel off the yellow skin before we eat it")

Observe Once

Encouraging Children to Communicate

7.3 Staff ask children appropriate questions, wait a reasonable time for child to respond and then answer if needed.
(Ex: " Are you hungry?" ... "Of course you are!"
"Where is the ball?"... "There it is!"
"Who just came in?"

Observe twice

Staff Use of Books with Children

7.1 Books used informally with children several different times during observation.

Observe for 2 different children at 2 different times

Staff Use of Books with Children

7.2 Staff usually encourage children to be actively involved in use of books with them (Ex: help infant to pat a picture or help turn a page; ask questions about the book that older toddlers can answer)

Observe for 2 different children at 2 different times

Encouraging Children's Use of Books

7.1 More than 20 books are accessible throughout the observation.

Encouraging Children's Use of Books

7.2 Staff provide extended positive interaction when child uses book independently (Ex: reads book to child that communicates that desire; responds to child's questions about a book; looks at and comments on pictures)

Observe once

Encouraging Children's Use of Books

7.3 Signs that accessible books are rotated (Ex: books about current seasonal or interests included; some new books present; library books accessible)

Fine Motor

7.2 Staff show extended interest as children use fine motor materials
(Ex: playfully engage children with materials; show how to string beads; talk with children about what they do/what they make)

Observe for 2 different children

Fine Motor

7.3 Staff use comments/questions to help children understand concepts (Ex: count materials with children; point out rattle noises or materials' differences in color, shape or size; talk about how interlocking blocks fit together)

Observe for 2 different children

Art

7.1 Art materials and activities are used to teach children concepts such as comparing colors, shape, size (Ex: “This paintbrush is bigger, see how it makes a thicker line”; This pencil is red just like your shirt”)

Observe once

Art

7.2 Staff use words and actions to teach children to use art materials (Ex: explain that playdough is not to eat; showing how to pat playdough or shape it into a ball; name paint color; show how to dip brush into paint and remove excess paint")

Observe once

Art

7.3 Staff talk extensively with children individually about their artwork (Ex: You used Red here and Blue over here Look you mixed red & blue to make purple; “you made lots of circles on the paper. See how the lines go around and around; “Tell me about your picture”)

Observe for 2 different children

Art

7.4 Staff write captions about artwork dictated by interested children that are 24 months and older (Ex: “You said “Ball”. See, I wrote your words. Your daddy can read it to you too!)

Music and Movement

7.2 Staff draw attention to features of the music (Ex: point out rhyming words; fast/slow tempos; connect movements to music, such as doing finger plays related to the words in a song; encourage slow movements during slow music and fast movements during fast music)

Observe once

Blocks

7.3 Staff talk about age appropriate concepts related to block play in a way that interests children
(Ex: compare block colors or shapes; sizes of structure such as tall/short, big/little, wide/narrow; count blocks while stacking or cleaning up; discuss texture of blocks such as hard or soft)

Observe once

Blocks

7.4 Staff model creating simple structures, such as towers, roads, or bridges, while describing what they are doing.

Observe once

Dramatic Play

7.3 Staff frequently join in the children's play, adding language appropriately (Ex: name food in both; call for delivery (use phone number, look at menus)

Observe 3 different children

Nature/Science

7.2 Staff show interest in and concern for nature (Ex: care for plants, respond to child's interest in pictures or pet; help child recycle materials; help child water plants; talk about birds you see outside)

Nature/Science

7.3 Staff draw children's attention to and appropriately talk about nature/science.

Observe 3 times

Math/Number

7.1 Staff help two year olds become aware of what printed numbers mean (Ex: point to the number and count the objects pictured on the page in a counting book; point to number on puzzle piece and count number of objects.)

Observe once

Math/Number

7.2 Staff use words to describe the sequence of daily events. (Ex: “First we put on our coats and second we go outside”; “Our number one job now is to clean up, then number two, we can wash our hands for lunch and number three we can eat lunch”.)

Math/Number

7.3 Staff show number of fingers when they use number to talk with children.

Observe once